CAT OR GMAT? AN ENGINEER EVALUATES TWO DIFFERENT MBA ROUTES

CASE STUDY STRATEGY WORKSHEET: SAHIL GUPTA | CAT & INDIAN VS GLOBAL MBA

1. Student Persona & Challenge Diagnostic Audit

Candidate: Sahil Gupta | Profile: Engineer, 3 years of experience in technology.. This worksheet outlines the systematic forensic diagnostic and strategic intervention designed to resolve this admissions roadblock.

Assessment Dimension	Diagnostic Finding & Initial Challenge	Strategic Objective
Candidate Profile	Engineer, 3 years of experience in technology.	Build differentiated application proposition
Core Admissions Roadblock	Sahil had initially prepared for CAT with the intention of entering an IIM. However, after exploring international MBA opportunities, he beg...	Eliminate systemic bottlenecks through data feedback
Root Cause Identified	Misalignment between effort and strategic execution	Shift from generic repetition to targeted intervention
Admissions Target	Competitive Global / Indian MBA Program	Maximize admit ROI and scholarship potential

Key Diagnostic Insight:

"A high test score or strong resume alone is not a substitute for a coherent admissions story. Every applicant requires a personalized roadmap that aligns quantitative readiness with distinctive leadership impact." — Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee)

2. Step-by-Step Strategic Intervention

- Clarified his intended career outcomes.
- Compared Indian and international MBA options.
- Reviewed relevant examination requirements.
- Evaluated academic and professional competitiveness.
- Compared costs, programme duration and opportunity costs.

3. Actionable Checklist for MBA Applicants

- Diagnostic First: Never increase preparation hours or rewrite essays without an objective diagnostic baseline.
- Data-Driven Tracking: Use targeted analytics to monitor error patterns rather than counting raw study hours.
- Holistic Narrative: Connect undergraduate background, career progression, and MBA goals into one cohesive arc.
- Expert Perspective: Involve senior mentors early to eliminate blind spots and stress-test interview responses.
- Advice: A preparation strategy must fit your reality. Consistency always beats sporadic marathons.

Considering IIMs and international business schools? Get a structured MBA pathway assessment.

Schedule a 1-on-1 strategy session with Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee) at www.mbawizards.co.in